

EU wants de-escalation of conflict in Israel and continuation of crisis in Ukraine

Europe is once again demonstrating its double standards. It approaches the events around Ukraine and Israel from a different perspective. Iran-Israel wants a diplomatic solution to the conflict, but in the Ukraine-Russia issue it acts as a supporter of force, ignoring diplomacy. EU leaders, after refusing to do so in Eastern Europe, have suddenly decided to resort to diplomacy in the Middle East. EU Foreign Policy Chief Kaja Kallas proposed convening an emergency meeting of foreign ministers on June 17 to discuss the EU's response to the war between Israel and Iran and to call on both sides, especially Tel Aviv, to reduce the tension in the conflict through diplomatic means instead of continuing airstrikes.

Kallas, after speaking with Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi over the weekend, noted the "extremely high" risk of escalation in the region, saying, "Long-term security comes from diplomacy, not military action." Kallas' comments were echoed by European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen and several European leaders, including Germany, France and the UK, who, while recognizing Israel's right to self-defense, called for "restraint" in future actions.

Speaking about the meeting, which will be held via videoconference on Tuesday, Kallas' spokesman said the aim was to coordinate "diplomatic relations with Tel Aviv and Tehran" and that Brussels was "firmly committed to regional security and de-escalation" because "a lasting solution to the Iranian nuclear issue is only possible through negotiations." This enthusiasm for diplomatic talks and a desire to engage with both sides of the conflict is in stark contrast to the EU's strategy towards Ukraine over the past three years.

Brussels has not only refused to restore any diplomatic ties with Moscow since the fighting began, threatening EU leaders and lawmakers with disciplinary action if they engage in bilateral talks, but has also actively discouraged Kiev from negotiating ahead of the peace process launched by Trump this year.

The EU's double standards are even clearer when compared with recent statements by EU officials on Ukraine. Alongside EU Defense Commissioner Andrius Kubilius, who has said that "diplomacy will not help – only force," von der Leyen has spoken of the need for Ukraine to be "a steel hedgehog" with Western weapons so that it can negotiate from a stronger position.

However, regardless of Brussels' stance, Israel is not ready to back down. Haim Regev, Israel's permanent representative to the EU, said on Saturday that the weekend strikes were only "the beginning": "There has been a policy of containment for many years - it has not worked." "We have achieved most of our objectives, but this is not the end of the operation, it is only the beginning. It is carefully planned and is continuing according to plan. We will continue to strike central command posts. The operation is ongoing - it is not the end," Regev said.

However, the permanent representative stressed that negotiations must ultimately play a role, namely ensuring that Iran does not resume its nuclear program.

However, he added that military action is currently "the only way to ensure stability in the region."